

OCD: mental rituals, reassurance and uncertainty

Original support worksheet | Adults | Reviewed 2026-10-10

Use fictional or appropriately de-identified notes. Write, draw, dictate or point. Not a validated measure, diagnostic test or crisis service.

Intrusion: Unwanted thought or doubt

Feared meaning: What it seems to say about me

Mental response: Review, neutralize, compare

Brief certainty: Relief fades; doubt returns

Return to life: Agreed response and valued action

Intrusion and feared meaning; no graphic details needed

Hidden reviewing/neutralizing and its stopping rule

Relief duration and activity interrupted

Valued practice to preserve; agreed response to discuss

Next step: who will do what, by when, and how will we review helpfulness or harm?

Assess suicidality, harm intention, coercion and medical concerns on their own merits. Intrusive content is not automatically intent, but an OCD formulation does not rule out co-occurring danger. Immediate danger uses local urgent care.